ceremonial guard of honour at Wellington Barracks in close vicinity of Buckingham Palace, where I took the salute and reviewed the parade in the presence of General Sir Mike Jackson, the chief of general staff of the British Army. My late grandfather and father would have felt equally honoured to witness this ceremony.



Reviewing the Guard of Honour at the Wellington Barracks near Buckingham Palace, accompanied by General Sir Mike Jackson.

Over the next four days there were meetings at the ministry of defence, the foreign office and visits to formations and institutions such as HQ Land Command at Wilton, the defence academy at Shrivenham and 2nd Division at Edinburgh. I was impressed to see the training facility created in the combined arms tactical trainer, where all arms manoeuvres could take place with live firing. The equipment display was very interesting as they had laid on a demonstration of their latest weapon systems and equipment. At the defence academy, I addressed the students on security issues and